

Phase 03 • Validate

Test ideas like a scientist.

FOUNDER'S NAME _____

START DATE _____

Hey, founder! Most business ideas are wrong, even grown-ups' ideas! The superpower is finding out FAST and CHEAP. In this phase you set your pass bar BEFORE every test, then let the results (not your hopes) make the decision. Watch out: mission 3.4 is the famous no-adult-help mission!

1 • In order

Do the tasks inside each mission in order, top to bottom.

2 • Evidence or it didn't happen

Every task's proof goes in your Founder File, labeled with the task number.

3 • Yes or no

A parent checks the "Done when" line and initials it. If you're debating, the answer is "not yet."

MISSION MAP • PHASE 03 • VALIDATE • 5 MISSIONS, 24 TASKS

- | | | |
|------------------------------|--|---------|
| ☐ 3.1 | Run at least 2 validation loops: hypothesis, test, outcome | 5 tasks |
| ☐ 3.2 | Run a pricing experiment: price points, margin math, and feedback from two groups | 5 tasks |
| ☐ 3.3 | Submit an AI-tool audit: your picks, your reasons, and what happened, for at least 3 tools | 5 tasks |
| ☐ 3.4 | Choose a validation path with NO adult help, then present your reasoning and outcome | 4 tasks |
| ☐ 3.5 | Publish two pieces of content that get engagement from outside your house | 5 tasks |

Your Founder File

On Day 1, set up one binder or folder called your **Founder File**. Every task's proof (logs, posters, photos, videos) goes in it, labeled with the task number. If the evidence isn't in the file, the task isn't done. By the end, the Founder File *is* your portfolio.



The Family Demo Session

Every other Saturday (or so), hold a **Family Demo Session**: a real event on the family calendar, phones down, audience assembled. This is where your demos, pitches, and presentations happen. Treat it like opening night, because it is.



The pencil rule

Work two or three blocks a week. Go at mastery speed, not calendar speed; fast or slow, both are on First Profit. Check a box only when the **Done when** line is true. When in doubt, the answer is "not yet," and that's fine. It just isn't done yet.

Run at least 2 validation loops: hypothesis, test, outcome

☐ 3.1.1 Build your loop sheet

A parent builds the template with five boxes: "We believe ____" / "We will ____" / "It's true if ____ happens by ____" / Result / Decision (keep going, change, or stop). Then YOU explain in your own words why the pass bar gets set BEFORE the test. That's the whole trick.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): The blank loop sheet is in the Founder File and you gave your explanation.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.1.2 Loop 1: write the bet before the test

Your parent suggests two testable questions about your business (Will people pay more? Does the flyer beat the post?). You pick one and fill in the sheet out loud: hypothesis, test plan, and pass bar. The test must be doable within two weeks and under your agreed cost cap.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): All three before-the-test boxes are filled in and dated BEFORE any testing starts.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.1.3 Loop 1: run it and decide

Run the test exactly as planned. Write down the result. Compare it to the bar you set. Write the decision. The decision follows the BAR, not your hopes! (Parent checks the logic.)

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): The result and decision boxes are complete, and the decision follows the bar.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.1.4 Loop 2: a different kind of bet

Write and date a second full loop that tests a DIFFERENT kind of question than Loop 1.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): Loop 2's three before-the-test boxes are complete and dated before testing.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.1.5 Loop 2: run it, then compare beliefs

Run Loop 2, write the result and decision. Then fill in the belief ledger (you can dictate it): "Before these loops I believed _____. Now I believe _____."

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): Both loops are complete in the file and the belief ledger is written.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

★ COMPLETES THE MISSION

Run a pricing experiment: price points, margin math, and feedback from two groups

☐ 3.2.1 Pick your test prices, and do the margin math FIRST

Choose at least two prices to test. Work out your profit per unit at EACH price before testing. Calculator fine, parent checks.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): The price points and correct margin math are in the file, dated before the test.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.2.2 Name your two customer groups

Pick two truly different groups (like neighbors vs. strangers at a market, or kids vs. adults) and how you'll reach each one.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): Both groups and their channels are written down and parent-approved.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.2.3 Test with Group 1

Offer your product at the test prices to Group 1. A parent is with you the whole time; YOU make the offers. Write down every response: what they said, what they paid or refused.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): At least five real responses from Group 1 are logged.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.2.4 Test with Group 2

Same offer, same careful recording, with Group 2 this time.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): At least five real responses from Group 2 are logged.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.2.5 Write your pricing verdict

A poster or page with: the price you chose, your profit at that price, how the two groups were different, and one surprise. Then defend your price out loud when a parent asks "Why not higher? Why not lower?"

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): The verdict page is in the Founder File and you defended your price out loud.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

★ COMPLETES THE MISSION

Submit an AI-tool audit: your picks, your reasons, and what happened, for at least 3 tools

☐ 3.3.1 List every tool you tried

List every AI tool you've used since Day 1, the keepers AND the ones you dumped, with one line each on what you tried it for. A parent helps you remember by flipping through the Founder File. Minimum five.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): The full inventory is in the Founder File.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.3.2 Tell the choosing story for three keepers

For three tools you still use: what job you hired it for, what else you considered, and why this one won. Three or four sentences each.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): All three choosing stories are written.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.3.3 Write what each keeper did for you

For each of the three: what it made possible, what it cost you (time or money), and whether it stays in your toolkit next phase.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): All three outcomes are written, each with a keep-or-drop verdict.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.3.4 Add one graveyard entry

Write up one tool you tried and abandoned: why you picked it, why it flopped, and what that taught you about picking tools.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): The graveyard entry is in the audit.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.3.5 Put it all together, and pass the quiz

A parent can assemble the audit from your pieces: inventory, three choosing stories, three outcomes, one graveyard entry. Then walk them through it. They point at ANY tool and ask, "What job does this one do?" You answer without notes.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): The assembled audit is in the Founder File and you passed the quiz.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

★ COMPLETES THE MISSION

Choose a validation path with NO adult help, then present your reasoning and outcome

Heads up! Parents: this mission is hands-off by design. Your only jobs are safety and audience. No tips, no fixes, no rescues, even if it's headed for a wall. Letting it fail is allowed and valuable.

☐ 3.4.1 The handover

You write your OWN validation plan (what to test, how, and what the pass bar is) completely alone. You may draw it or dictate it to a voice recording (NOT to a parent). Seal it in an envelope or a dated file before any discussion.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): The sealed, dated plan exists, and your parent confirms they gave zero input.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.4.2 Run the test solo

Do your plan. Your parent supervises for safety ONLY: no suggestions, no course corrections. If it fails, that's allowed, and valuable.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): The test has run, and YOUR own record of what happened is in the Founder File.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.4.3 Build the presentation alone

Poster, show-and-tell, or slides, any format. Cover: why you chose this test, how you ran it, and what happened, including anything that went wrong. No adult editing.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): The presentation materials exist, made entirely by you.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.4.4 Present, then open the envelope

Deliver it at a scheduled Family Demo Session. The audience asks questions but offers NO fixes. Afterward, open the sealed plan together and compare: did you do what you said you'd do?

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): The presentation is delivered and recorded, and the plan-vs-actual comparison is noted in the Founder File.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

★ COMPLETES THE MISSION

Publish two pieces of content that get engagement from outside your house

☐ 3.5.1 Pick the platform and set the rules

With a parent, decide where your content will live (a parent's account; that's the rule), what formats you'll make, and the publishing safety rules: nothing that identifies you, and a parent approves every post. Sign the rules together.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): Platform, formats, and the signed publishing rules are in the Founder File.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.5.2 Make and publish Piece 1

Create your first piece about your business or your building journey. You create it; a parent edits lightly and posts it.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): Piece 1 is live and the link or screenshot is filed.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.5.3 Piece 2: change one thing on purpose

BEFORE making Piece 2, write down one deliberate change based on how Piece 1 did: topic, format, hook, or time of day. Then make it and publish it.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): Your pre-declared change and the live Piece 2 are both filed.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.5.4 Track engagement for a week

For at least seven days after each piece, track engagement from people OUTSIDE your household: comments, shares, saves, messages. If a piece gets zero outside engagement, make one more piece (repeat the change step) until two pieces have it. The bar stays real!

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): Screenshots of outside engagement on both pieces are in the Founder File.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

☐ 3.5.5 Write the content verdict

Three lines (dictating is fine): which piece did better, by which number, and your best theory why.

DONE WHEN (PARENT CHECKS): The verdict is in the Founder File.

PARENT INITIALS _____ DATE _____

★ COMPLETES THE MISSION

Phase 03 · Validate: Complete!

Every task above is initialed and dated, and every piece of evidence is in the Founder File. We checked, no debating!

FOUNDER'S SIGNATURE

PARENT / VERIFIER SIGNATURE

DATE PHASE PASSED